Ali Pooralijan

Backend Systems Engineer

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I build performance-sensitive libraries in Rust, with Python at the boundary through PyO3. cachebox is a thread-safe in-memory cache (428 GitHub stars, 13M+ monthly PyPI downloads), and markupever is an HTML and XML parser on html5ever. I also ship production backends, including an AI gateway over 162+ models. I add a UI when a product needs one. Three years of that production work has been REST APIs, relational schemas, and S3 pipelines.

SKILLS

Languages: Rust, Python, TypeScript, TypeSpec, SQL

Frameworks: Actix Web, Axum, FastAPI, TanStack Start, Next.js, React

Developer Tools: Git, Docker, Nginx, GitHub Actions, Maturin, Orval, S3

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, Dragonfly, MongoDB

Libraries: PyO3, Tokio, html5ever, SQLAlchemy

PROJECTS

cachebox · High-performance Python cache

2024 - Present

Rust, PyO3, Maturin — https://github.com/awolverp/cachebox

- Designed and maintain cachebox, a thread-safe in-memory cache and memoization library for Python, implemented in Rust with PyO3.
- Used in projects by Google and AWS, and as a core dependency of DeepDiff (+18M weekly downloads).
- 428 GitHub stars and 13M+ PyPI downloads per month. CPython and PyPy wheels ship through Maturin and GitHub Actions.
- FIFO, LRU, TTL, and other eviction policies with a low memory footprint. cachebox-benchmark shows 10–50× vs common Python caches.

markupever · HTML and XML parser

2024 - Present

Rust, PyO3, Maturin — https://github.com/awolverp/markupever

- Designed and maintain markupever, an HTML and XML parser for Python. The Rust core uses html5ever, exposed through PyO3.
- 37 GitHub stars and 360K+ downloads on PyPI.

HeroAI · Unified AI Gateway API

Dec 2024 - Present

Python, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, S3 — https://api.heroai.ir/docs

- Shipped OpenAI- and Gemini-compatible REST APIs so existing SDKs and apps integrate with little or no code changes.
- Implemented API key management, reseller APIs, org/team admin, enterprise data policies, and credit-based billing.
- Supported 14K+ users and 48M+ monthly API requests over 162+ models; used by WordPress plugins and third-party integrations.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer · Freelance

Remote | Aug 2025 - Present

- Build production backends in FastAPI and Actix Web.
- Shipped HeroAI, a unified AI gateway over 162+ models serving 14K+ users and 48M+ monthly requests, as contract work with Zhaket.
- Backend specialist with the frontend skills to ship full products in TanStack Start or Next.js.

Open Source Developer · Self-employed

Aug 2023 - Present

- Author and maintain Rust libraries on PyPI through PyO3.
- Creator of cachebox (428 stars, 13M+ monthly downloads), markupever (37 stars, 360K+ downloads), and rapidquery.

EDUCATION

Computer Engineering

Sep 2023 - 2028

Engineer's Degree — Payame Noor University